

PlayIQ Module 4: Lesson Rescue Mode

Your mission: find the one missing piece

Have you ever looked at a lesson and thought, "I understand every word, but I still do not understand what this means"?

That feeling does not mean you are bad at the subject. It usually means there is a specific missing piece hiding inside the lesson. In this module, you will learn how to find that piece and ask Orion for the right kind of help.

By the end of this module, I can:

- turn "I do not get it" into a precise diagnosis;
- recognize six common kinds of learning gaps;
- use chunking to locate where confusion begins;
- compare three rescue methods on the same real problem;
- choose a rescue setting for Orion to test, not a permanent label;
- teach back a rescued lesson in my own words;
- add evidence from this module to my future personal tutor Project.

ORION: "Confusion is not a dead end. It is a signal. If we can find the

exact point where the signal began, we can choose a smaller and smarter next

move. Ready to turn confusion into a map?"

Part 0: The 30-second rescue hook

Read this sentence once:

The membrane is selectively permeable, so some substances cross by diffusion

while others require transport proteins.

Do not solve it. Just circle the first place where your understanding becomes

less clear:

- ☐ `membrane`
- ☐ `selectively permeable`
- ☐ why some substances cross
- ☐ why transport proteins are needed
- ☐ I know the pieces, but not how the sentence fits together
- ☐ the whole sentence arrived too quickly

There is no wrong choice. You just did the first move of Lesson Rescue Mode:

you replaced "all of this is confusing" with "my confusion begins here."

Why this matters: a vague request usually produces a vague explanation. A

precise rescue signal gives Orion a much better chance of helping with the

actual missing piece.

My first rescue signal was:

Part 1: Confusion is information

When you are stuck, your brain may want to escape, reread everything, or ask

for the complete answer. Those reactions are normal, but they do not always

repair the problem.

Lesson Rescue Mode follows four moves:

1. **Stop** at the first unclear point.
2. **Name** the likely gap.
3. **Choose** one rescue method.
4. **Prove** the rescue by explaining or using the idea yourself.

This is not about making every lesson instantly easy. It is about reducing a large confusing problem into the next learnable step.

Orion conversation: from fog to a target

STUDENT: "I do not understand this chapter."

ORION: "Let us make that smaller. Which paragraph is the first one that stops making sense?"

STUDENT: "The second paragraph."

ORION: "Which word, step, or connection inside it is unclear?"

STUDENT: "I know the words, but I do not know why the equation changes on line three."

ORION: "Good diagnosis. That sounds like a possible step gap. I will show only the move between lines two and three, then you will try a similar move."

Notice what happened: Orion did not replace the student's thinking or finish the whole assignment. Orion helped identify the missing step and then returned the work to the student.

Part 2: The six gap types

The same confused feeling can come from different causes. Use these six types as possibilities, not medical diagnoses or permanent traits.

1. Word gap

An important word, symbol, phrase, or instruction is unclear.

Example: You cannot follow a history question because you do not know what evaluate means in that question.

Useful Orion request:

"In this sentence, explain the word evaluate in plain language. Give one

example of what it asks me to do and one thing it does not ask me to do."

2. Background gap

The lesson assumes you already know an earlier idea.

Example: Factoring quadratics feels impossible because multiplying binomials was never fully understood.

Useful Orion request:

"Ask me three short questions to find the earlier idea I may be missing. Do

not solve the current problem for me."

3. Step gap

You understand the starting point and maybe the ending, but one move in the middle is missing.

Example: You follow the first two steps in a chemistry calculation and then do not know why the units change.

Useful Orion request:

"Show only the missing move between these two lines. Explain why that move is

allowed, then give me a similar move to try."

4. Connection gap

You understand separate facts but not how they influence one another.

Example: You know what supply and demand mean separately, but not why a shortage can affect price.

Useful Orion request:

"Connect these two ideas using one cause-and-effect chain and one real-world

example. Then ask me to explain the connection back."

5. Overload gap

Too much information is arriving at once, so you cannot see where to begin.

Example: A page contains seven new terms, two diagrams, and a long explanation.

Useful Orion request:

"Break this into no more than three chunks. Tell me which chunk to understand

first and hide the later details until I ask for them."

6. Expectation gap

You may understand the topic but not what the task, teacher, rubric, or question expects you to produce.

Example: You know the novel, but you are unsure whether the assignment asks for a summary, an argument, or evidence-based analysis.

Useful Orion request:

"Translate this instruction into a checklist. Do not write the response.

Show me what a successful answer must demonstrate."

Quick gap practice

Match each situation with the gap that seems most likely. More than one answer can be reasonable if you explain your evidence.

1. "I know every vocabulary word, but I cannot tell why event A caused event

B." Likely gap: _____ Evidence: _____

2. "The teacher went from line 2 to line 3 and I cannot reproduce the move."

Likely gap: _____ Evidence: _____

3. "I studied the topic, but I do not know what compare and contrast requires

in the final answer." Likely gap: _____ Evidence: _____

4. "The whole page feels like ten things at once." Likely gap: _____

Evidence: _____

ORION: "Your first gap choice is a hypothesis. We test it. If the rescue

does not help, we change the hypothesis instead of blaming you."

Part 3: Chunking—the confusion scanner

Chunking means dividing material into small enough pieces that you can locate the first breakdown.

The line-by-line scan

Use a short, school-approved paragraph or worked example. Do not upload private information or another student's work.

1. Read only the first sentence or step.
2. Mark it:
 - `G` = I get it well enough to explain it.
 - `M` = maybe; I recognize it but cannot explain it yet.
 - `S` = stop; this is where I lose the thread.
3. Continue only until the first M or S.
4. Underline the exact word, step, or connection causing the uncertainty.
5. Name a possible gap type.

My confusion scan

Topic or lesson: _____

Source used: _____

First clear chunk:

First M or S chunk:

Exact unclear word, step, connection, amount of information, or expectation:

My first gap hypothesis: _____

Why I chose it:

Why this activity matters

If you ask Orion to explain an entire chapter, you may receive another entire chapter. The scan helps you preserve what you already understand and focus energy only where it is needed.

Part 4: Learn How You Learn discovery

Answer from real experience. There are no ideal answers.

1. When confusion starts, what do you usually do first—reread, guess, ask, pause, search, or something else?

2. What makes you more likely to ask for help?

3. What sometimes stops you from asking for help?

4. Think of a recent lesson that finally clicked. What changed—the words, the example, the steps, the connection, the amount shown, or the instructions?

5. When someone gives you the whole answer while you are stuck, what do you gain and what do you lose?

Gain: _____

Lose: _____

6. What should Orion do if its first rescue attempt does not help?

These answers are clues for the tutor you will build later. They are not fixed statements about what your brain can or cannot do.

Part 5: Active comparison—three rescue methods

Now test three methods on the **same confusing chunk**. Keeping the chunk the same makes the comparison more useful.

Before starting, write what you currently understand in one sentence:

Write the question you still cannot answer:

Method A: Analogy rescue

Prompt:

"Act as my learning coach. I am confused about [exact chunk]. My possible

gap is [gap type]. Explain only that missing piece with one simple analogy.

Tell me where the analogy stops being accurate. Then ask me one check

question. Do not complete my assignment."

One thing the analogy clarified:

One limit or confusing part:

Check question result: ☐ correct ☐ partly correct ☐ not yet

Method B: Step-by-step rescue

Prompt:

"Act as my learning coach. I am confused about [exact chunk]. Show the

smallest sequence of steps needed to connect what I know to what I am

missing. Pause after each step for me to explain it back. Do not finish the

school task for me."

The step where understanding improved:

The step that still needs work:

Check question result: ☐ correct ☐ partly correct ☐ not yet

Method C: Diagnostic-question rescue

Prompt:

"Act as my learning coach. Ask me up to three short questions, one at a time,

to locate my exact confusion about [chunk]. After my answers, name the likely

gap and give one hint. Do not give the final answer."

The question that exposed the gap:

The hint I used:

Check question result: ☐ correct ☐ partly correct ☐ not yet

Fair comparison check

- ☐ I used the same topic or closely matched material.
- ☐ I attempted an answer after each rescue.
- ☐ I did not ask Orion to complete the assignment.
- ☐ I recorded what happened, even if no method fully worked.

Part 6: Evidence capture and interpretation

Use your own ratings. They are evidence from this one experiment, not official performance metrics.

Rescue method	Understanding before (1–5)	Understanding after (1–5)	Frustration after (1–5)	Hints needed	Could I explain it?
Analogy	_____	_____	_____	_____	Yes / Partly / Not yet
Steps	_____	_____	_____	_____	Yes / Partly / Not yet

Questions	_____	_____	_____	_____	Yes / Partly / Not yet
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Which method produced the clearest improvement in this experiment?

What evidence supports that answer?

Did another method help in a different way?

What might have affected the result—topic difficulty, prior knowledge, prompt quality, tiredness, time pressure, or something else?

Interpret without labeling yourself

Do not conclude, "I am an analogy learner" or "I can only learn through steps." A safer conclusion is:

"For this topic, under these conditions, _____ helped because

_____. I will let Orion try it first next time and test whether it still

helps."

My evidence-based conclusion:

Part 7: Learning Supercharger Blueprint update

Your Learning Supercharger Blueprint tells your future tutor **how to begin a test**, not how it must teach you forever.

Think of it like choosing Orion's first move:

- If the move helps, keep using it where it works.
- If another move works better, revise the setting.
- If the topic changes, test again.
- If you still feel stuck, Orion should diagnose another gap instead of

repeating the same explanation louder or longer.

Proposed tutor setting

rescue-start = [analogy | step-by-step | diagnostic-questions | not-yet-known]

when-to-use = _____

evidence = _____

fallback = _____

Write the rule in plain language:

"When I say I am stuck, first help me locate the exact gap. For this kind of

topic, begin with _____. If I cannot explain the idea after the

check question, try _____ next."

Is this rule ready to use?

- [] `experiment\_result` — supported by today's comparison
- [] `student\_reported` — I prefer it, but need more testing
- [] `pending\_validation` — the result was unclear

Part 8: Structured Knowledge File update

Add this record to Learning_Rules.md or the equivalent approved knowledge

file. Replace the brackets with your own evidence. Keep the source and status

so your future personal tutor knows where the rule came from.

```
- rule_id: module_4_rescue_start
module: 4
skill_tested: lesson_rescue
date: "[YYYY-MM-DD]"
source_activity: "analogy_vs_steps_vs_questions_comparison"
confusing_topic: "[topic]"
gap_hypothesis: "[word|background|step|connection|overload|expectation]"
preferred_first_move: "[method or not_yet_known]"
evidence:
understanding_change: "[what changed]"
frustration_observation: "[what happened]"
hints_needed: "[number or unknown]"
teach_back_result: "[yes|partly|not_yet]"
provenance: "[experiment_result|student_reported|pending_validation]"
confidence: "[low|medium|high]"
fallback_method: "[method or pending_validation]"
privacy: "safe_for_tutor_project"
review_condition: "Retest with a different subject or when the rule stops helping."
```

Show Orion what changed:

"Orion, read my Module 4 record back to me. Separate what the experiment

showed from what I only reported. Do not turn one result into a permanent

learning-style label. Tell me which field still needs validation."

One field Orion said needs more evidence:

Part 9: Proof Artifact—Lesson Rescue Report

Complete this in your own words.

```
=====
PLAYIQ LESSON RESCUE REPORT
=====
Student: _____ Date: _____
Lesson/topic: _____
Source used: _____

The exact point where confusion began:
_____

My first gap hypothesis:
[ word | background | step | connection | overload | expectation ]

Evidence for that hypothesis:
_____

Methods tested: [ analogy ] [ steps ] [ diagnostic questions ]

The first method Orion should test next time: _____
Why: _____
Fallback method: _____

Before the rescue, I thought:
_____

After the rescue, I can now explain:
_____

Rule status:
[ experiment_result | student_reported | pending_validation ]
=====
```

Save this artifact for your final personal tutor Project. It gives Orion both
a possible rescue rule and the evidence behind it.

Part 10: Mastery Challenge—rescue a real lesson

Choose one small section from current, school-approved material. Your goal is
not to finish the whole assignment. Your goal is to prove that you can repair
one real gap.

1. Run the line-by-line confusion scan.

2. Name a gap hypothesis.
3. Ask Orion for your proposed first rescue method.
4. Attempt a new example or explanation yourself.
5. If the first rescue fails, test the fallback.
6. Complete the teach-back below without copying Orion's wording.

Teach-back record

The section is about:

The exact gap was:

The missing piece was:

Here is the idea in my own words:

One example is:

One check question I can answer now is:

My answer:

I still need to verify or practice:

Mastery check

- [] I located a specific gap instead of saying everything was confusing.

- ☐ I asked Orion for teaching help, not a completed answer.
- ☐ I tried the idea myself after the rescue.
- ☐ I explained what changed in my own words.
- ☐ I saved the proof artifact and knowledge-file record.

If one box is not checked, that is your next step—not a failure.

ORION: "You just learned how to turn overwhelm into a target. In Module

5, you will go the other direction: take a large topic you understand in

pieces and compress it into a small, accurate map you can actually use."

Beta tester feedback—complete only in the beta route

This section appears only after the module is complete in the beta-testing route. Standard-course students do not complete it.

1. Which rescue activity felt most useful, and why?

2. Where were the instructions unclear, slow, or boring?

3. Did the six gap types make confusion easier to describe? Which one needs a better example?

4. Did Orion help you think, or did any prompt make it too easy to avoid the thinking?

5. What would make Lesson Rescue Mode more fun without making it less useful?

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